Students Studying in Canada

WORKING WHILE STUDYING

Updated April 14th, 2026

Learn more about studying in Canada (/ogs/canada)

WORK ON CAMPUS

You can work on-campus as an international student without a Work Permit if you meet the three criteria below:

1. You have a valid study permit with a condition allowing you to work;

2. You are a full-time student at Northeastern University;

3. You have a Social Insurance Number (https://international.northeastern.edu/ogs/student-support/global-campuses/canada/social-insurance-number/) (SIN)

You must stop working on-campus:

- on the day you stop studying full-time
- when your study permit expires
- if you're on an authorized leave from your studies
- if you're switching schools and aren't currently studying

You can return to work only once you're back to studying and you meet all the requirements to work on-campus.

Please also be aware of the Northeastern University policies (https://policies.northeastern.edu/policy808/) about working on campus as an international student. Students are only allowed to work 20 hours per week for an on-campus job during the school term, and up to 40 hours during scheduled breaks.

WORK OFF CAMPUS

Starting Nov 8, 2024, You can work off-campus as an international student without a Work Permit up to 24 hours per week or full-time during the scheduled school breaks if you meet the four criteria below:

1. You have a valid study permit that includes a condition stating you may work off campus;

2. You are a full-time student at Northeastern University;

3. You have a Social Insurance Number (SIN);

4. You need to have full time student status, before and after the scheduled break.

For more information please see the IRCC webpage here (https://www.canada.ca/en/immigration-refugees-citizenship/services/study-canada/work/work-off-campus.html).

If you are a part time student
You can work off-campus only if:

- You meet **all** the requirements above **and**

- You're only studying part-time, instead of full time, because:

    - You're in the last semester of your program and you don't need a full course load to complete your program **and**

    - You were a full-time student in your program in Canada, up until your last semester

Note: You can only start working on or off campus when you start your program. You can't work before your studies begin.

STUDENT WORK PLACEMENT

Changes to co-op work permit requirements for post-secondary international students

As of April 1, 2026, you don't need a co-op work permit for student work placements, such as co-ops or internships, as a post-secondary international student.

For details about eligibility requirements of working in a student work placement, please visit: Student Work Placement (https://international.northeastern.edu/ogs/student-support/global-campuses/canada/student-work-placement/)

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